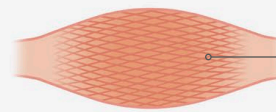


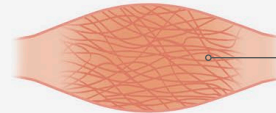


Movement and fascia

Research suggests that the collagen fibers of the fascia surrounding healthy muscles are organized in a crisscross, lattice structure. Inactivity and aging seem to cause your fascia to lose its structural integrity. Asana may help organize your fascia, helping you move and feel better.



Healthy double
lattice collagen
orientation



Random collagen
orientation from
inactivity

COLLAGEN FIBERS

Agonist

Biceps brachii is the agonist as it concentrically contracts to flex the elbow

Flexion
Angle of joint
decreases

Antagonist

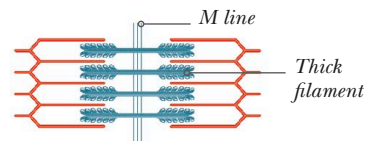
Triceps brachii is the antagonist as it mostly relaxes

CONCENTRIC CONTRACTION

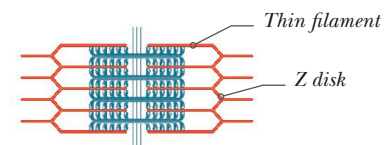
Concentric contractions occur when the muscle fibers “shorten” to change the angle of a joint. This occurs in your biceps when flexing your elbow as you lift a weight, or in your hamstrings when flexing your knee as you move into Warrior II (see pp.102–05).

Muscle contraction

A cascade of events initiated by a signal from the nervous system and the presence of calcium leads to the removal of the blockage on actin of the thin filament, allowing the thick and thin filament to connect. The thick filament pulls the thin filament in toward the M-line, bringing the Z-disks closer together.



RELAXED SARCOMERE



CONTRACTED SARCOMERE